

Logos 聚会

2026-07-04

使徒行传 8:1- 17

关键成果

本次圣经学习涵盖了使徒行传第 8

章,重点讨论了司提反殉道如何成为福音扩展的催化剂、腓利在撒玛利亚的宣教、与行邪术的西门的相遇,以及圣灵在救恩中的角色与五旬节能力赋予之间的神学重要问题。小组讨论了逼迫如何成为神实现耶稣大使命的工具——

将福音从耶路撒冷传到犹太全地、撒玛利亚,直到地极。围绕区分圣灵在悔改中的内住工作与五旬节和撒玛利亚所见的圣灵外在"浇灌",展开了实质性的神学讨论。

所做决定

- **使徒行传第 8 章标志着一个重要的结构转折点:**第 1-7 章以耶路撒冷为中心;第 8-12 章涵盖犹太和撒玛利亚;第 13 章及以后延伸到地极。
- **逼迫是神的护理计划,而非灾难——**它使信徒分散,并实现了耶稣在使徒行传第 1 章中的应许,即福音将传到撒玛利亚及更远的地方。
- **腓利(传福音的腓利,而非使徒腓利)**是被选为服事早期教会行政事务的七位执事之一,但他积极传讲福音——表明传福音不仅仅是使徒或牧师的专属职责。
- **真诚和宗教虔诚并不能保证与神一致——**
扫罗/保罗受过高等教育,极其虔诚,真心相信自己在逼迫基督徒时是在捍卫神,但他实际上是在敌对神。
- **行邪术的西门真正的属灵状态在此时的经文中仍未解决;**他内在的转变值得怀疑,将在下次聚会中进一步考察。
- **必须区分圣灵的两种不同工作:**(1)使人能够相信和得救的内在工作,以及(2)五旬节所见的外在"浇灌"或能力赋予——可见的、有形的、可外部确认的。

神学讨论:扫罗赞同司提反之死

- **扫罗(后来的保罗)在司提反被石头打死时在场,并"赞同"这次杀害——**
但希腊原文的含义比被动同意更强烈。

- 希腊词语暗示扫罗完全同意、乐见其成,并积极赞同司提反之死——不仅仅是旁观者,而是自愿的参与者。
- 扫罗在著名的法利赛教师迦玛列门下受过高等教育,热心律法——用今天的话说,相当于在最好的宗教导师门下获得博士或博士后学位。
- 他相信自己在逼迫基督徒时是在捍卫神和维护律法,但实际上是在敌对神——这一事实他后来才认识到。
- 耶稣已经在约翰福音 16:2 中预言了这种模式:人们会杀害信徒,以为是在事奉神。
- 关键教训:宗教热心和真诚并不等于敬虔——虔诚、受过教育的人可能真诚地错误并积极有害。

神学讨论:大逼迫与福音扩展

- 司提反殉道后,耶路撒冷爆发了大规模逼迫,信徒分散到犹太和撒玛利亚各地——只有使徒留下。
- 当时耶路撒冷的基督徒群体可能有数万人——彼得的一次讲道就带来了 3000 人,后续聚会又增加了数千人(这些数字中未计入妇女和儿童)。
- 从人的角度看,这是一场灾难;从神的角度看,这是祂计划的下一步——使用逼迫作为在地理上传播福音的手段。
- 这实现了耶稣的大使命:"你们要在耶路撒冷、犹太全地、撒玛利亚,直到地极,作我的见证"(使徒行传第 1 章)。

腓利在撒玛利亚的宣教

- 撒玛利亚人被犹太人鄙视,认为他们种族不纯——是犹太人与外邦人通婚的产物——他们有自己的敬拜地点(一座山,而非耶路撒冷)和自己版本的经文。
- 犹太人在犹太和加利利之间旅行时会完全绕过撒玛利亚,认为即使接触撒玛利亚的土地也是不洁的。
- 腓利打破了这一文化禁忌,直接进入撒玛利亚传道——呼应了耶稣自己在约翰福音第 4 章中与撒玛利亚妇人在井边的刻意接触。
- 腓利首先传讲基督,神迹(医治、赶鬼、医治瘫痪和瘸腿的人)随后作为他信息的确认——而非相反。
- 正确的顺序很重要:神的话语是首要的;神迹确认信息并帮助人们相信,但目标始终是对福音的信心,而非对神迹的吸引。

- 撒玛利亚人**"同心合意地听从"**,并且**"在那城里,就大有欢喜"**——
他们的喜乐根植于救恩,而非奇观。
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行邪术的西门:真信与假信

- 西门长期通过邪术使撒玛利亚人惊奇,被认为是**"神的大能者"**——
他的能力来自撒但,而非神。
 - 当腓利到来时,西门**也信了,并且受了洗**,并紧紧跟随腓利,对所行的神迹奇事甚是惊奇。
 - 腓利和西门之间的关键区别:**腓利指向基督并寻求神的荣耀;西门寻求自己的荣耀,希望人们的注意力集中在自己身上。**
 - 这一区别适用于今天:**真正的属灵领袖将荣耀归给神;假领袖吸引注意力、赞美和资源到自己身上。**
 - 西门**真正的属灵状态值得商榷**——
他受了洗并在外表上跟随腓利,但他的内在转变似乎不完全;下一段经文(将在下次聚会中学习)将揭示他的真实动机。
 - 在他悔改(如果是真的)之后,西门**可能不再能行邪术**,因为真正的信徒不能同时服事神并从撒但那里获得能力。
 - 小组指出**假神迹是真实的,但源于撒但**——
神龕、符咒和仪式可以产生有形的效果,但这些来自仇敌,而非神。
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彼得和约翰被差往撒玛利亚:圣灵问题

- 撒玛利亚人领受神道的消息传到耶路撒冷,使徒们**打发彼得和约翰往撒玛利亚去**——
这是一个具有历史意义的接纳行为。
 - **这不是一次小的行政访问**:它象征着教会跨越犹太-撒玛利亚分歧的合一,确认撒玛利亚人现在是基督身体的正式成员。
 - 约翰的在场尤其令人感动:**在他早期的事工中,约翰曾请求耶稣从天上降火烧灭一个拒绝他们的撒玛利亚村庄**——但现在他来祝福并为撒玛利亚人祷告。
 - 约翰的这种转变——**从仇恨到爱**——
被引用为**圣灵真正内在更新的证据**,与约翰一书、二书和三书中对爱的强调一致。
 - 使徒们为撒玛利亚人**按手祷告**,之后撒玛利亚人领受了圣灵——
尽管他们已经相信并受了洗。
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神学讨论:圣灵的两种工作

这是本次聚会中最详细的神学交流,讨论了一段真正有争议的经文。

核心问题

- 撒玛利亚人已经**相信、受洗并接受了神的道**——
但经文说圣灵"还没有降在他们一个人身上"。
- 这引发了一个问题:**在使徒为他们按手之前,他们真的得救了吗?**

区别解释

确定了三个相关但不同的概念:

1. **圣灵在悔改中的内在工作**:没有圣灵打开人的心,没有人能相信。这项工作是看不见的、内在的——它使救恩成为可能。每个真正的信徒都经历过这一点。
2. **圣灵的洗(保罗的用法)**:在保罗的书信中,"圣灵的洗"指的是悔改——通过信心与基督联合。这是内在的、重生的工作。
3. **圣灵的"浇灌"/五旬节能力赋予(耶稣在使徒行传第 1 章中的用法)**:这是一种独特的、外在的、可见的、有形的经历——在五旬节以火、风和方言的形式出现,并在其他场合重复出现,当时地面震动。

关键结论

- **撒玛利亚人在使徒到来之前已经得救**——他们的相信和接受神的道需要圣灵的内在工作。
- **按手和领受圣灵**是一种外在的、五旬节式的能力赋予——
外部可察觉(西门能看到它发生),作为神的印记,确认撒玛利亚人被完全接纳为神的子民。
- 这种外在的能力赋予**不是一次性事件**——
它在使徒行传中多次重复(例如,当信徒在逼迫下聚集时,地方震动)。
- **约翰福音第 4 章中撒玛利亚妇人的悔改**被引用为一个平行例子:她和通过她的见证而相信的撒玛利亚人真正得救了,没有任何外在的五旬节神迹。
- **警惕极端**:一些灵恩派/五旬节派传统错误地要求可见的外在神迹作为救恩的证明——
这是不正确的。圣经的标准是"口里承认,心里相信"(罗马书第 10 章)。
- 信徒可以并且应该寻求**被圣灵充满**(以弗所书 5:18)——
这是一种合法的持续追求,与得救的时刻不同。

传福音是每个信徒的责任

- 腓利和司提反被选为**执事,负责行政/服务角色**(管理对寡妇的救济等),但两人都大有能力地传讲福音。
- 这表明**传道和作见证不是牧师或宣教士的专属——**
每个基督徒都被呼召作耶稣基督的见证人。
- 早期教会以**普通信徒作为积极的传福音者**运作,而非专业事工的被动接受者。
- 小组挑战了"传福音是牧师的工作"这种常见的**教会态度**,认为这是不符合圣经的。

Logos Meeting

Acts 8:1 - 17, 2026-07-04

Key Outcomes

This Bible study session covered Acts Chapter 8, focusing on the martyrdom of Stephen as a catalyst for gospel expansion, Philip's mission to Samaria, the encounter with Simon the Sorcerer, and the theologically significant question of the Holy Spirit's role in salvation versus Pentecostal empowerment. The group discussed how persecution became God's instrument for fulfilling Jesus's Great Commission — spreading the gospel from Jerusalem to Judea, Samaria, and the ends of the earth. A substantive theological discussion emerged around distinguishing the indwelling work of the Holy Spirit in conversion from the outward "pouring out" of the Spirit seen at Pentecost and in Samaria.

Decisions Made

- **Acts 8 marks a major structural turning point** in the Book of Acts: Chapters 1–7 center on Jerusalem; Chapters 8–12 cover Judea and Samaria; Chapters 13 onward extend to the ends of the earth.
 - **Persecution was God's providential plan**, not a disaster — it scattered believers and fulfilled Jesus's promise in Acts 1 that the gospel would reach Samaria and beyond.
 - **Philip (the Evangelist, not the Apostle)** was one of the seven deacons chosen to serve the early church administratively, yet he actively preached the gospel — demonstrating that evangelism is not reserved for apostles or pastors alone.
 - **Sincerity and religious devotion do not guarantee alignment with God** — Saul/Paul was highly educated, deeply devout, and genuinely believed he was defending God while persecuting Christians, yet he was actively opposing God.
 - **Simon the Sorcerer's true spiritual status remains unresolved** at this point in the text; his inner transformation is questionable and will be examined further in the next session.
 - **Two distinct works of the Holy Spirit** must be distinguished: (1) the inward work enabling belief and salvation, and (2) the outward "pouring out" or empowerment seen at Pentecost — visible, tangible, and externally confirmable.
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Theological Discussion: Saul's Approval of Stephen's Death

- **Saul (later Paul) was present at Stephen's stoning** and "approved" of the killing — but the Greek original carries a stronger meaning than passive consent.
 - The Greek word implies **Saul fully agreed, took pleasure in, and actively consented** to Stephen's death — not merely a bystander but a willing participant.
 - Saul was **highly educated under Gamaliel**, a prominent Pharisee teacher, and was zealous for the Law — comparable in today's terms to a PhD or post-doctoral scholar under the best religious mentor.
 - He **believed he was defending God and upholding the Law** when persecuting Christians, but was in reality opposing God — a fact he only recognized later.
 - Jesus had already **prophesied this pattern in John 16:2**: people would kill believers thinking they were serving God.
 - Key lesson: **Religious zeal and sincerity do not equal godliness** — devout, educated people can be sincerely wrong and actively harmful.
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Theological Discussion: The Great Persecution and Gospel Expansion

- Following Stephen's martyrdom, **large-scale persecution broke out in Jerusalem**, scattering believers throughout Judea and Samaria — with only the apostles remaining.
 - The Christian community in Jerusalem at that time likely numbered **tens of thousands** — Peter's single sermon brought 3,000, and subsequent gatherings added thousands more (women and children not counted in those figures).
 - From a human perspective, this was a disaster; **from God's perspective, it was the next step in His plan** — using persecution as the means to spread the gospel geographically.
 - This fulfilled Jesus's commission: **"You will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, Judea, Samaria, and to the ends of the earth"** (Acts 1).
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Philip's Mission to Samaria

- **Samaritans were despised by Jews** as racially impure — the product of intermarriage between Jews and Gentiles — with their own worship site (a mountain, not Jerusalem) and their own version of scripture.

- Jews would **detour entirely around Samaria** when traveling between Judea and Galilee, considering even contact with Samaritan land as unclean.
 - Philip **broke this cultural taboo** by going directly into Samaria to preach — mirroring Jesus's own intentional engagement with the Samaritan woman at the well in John 4.
 - Philip **preached Christ first**, and miracles (healings, casting out unclean spirits, healing the paralyzed and lame) followed as confirmation of his message — not the reverse.
 - The correct order matters: **the Word was primary; signs confirmed the message** and helped people believe, but the goal was always faith in the gospel, not attraction to miracles.
 - The Samaritans "**listened with one accord**" and "**there was great joy in that city**" — their joy was rooted in salvation, not spectacle.
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Simon the Sorcerer: True vs. False Belief

- **Simon had long amazed the people of Samaria** through sorcery and was considered "the Great Power of God" — his power derived from Satan, not God.
 - When Philip arrived, Simon **also believed and was baptized**, and followed Philip closely, marveling at the signs and great miracles performed.
 - Key distinction between Philip and Simon: **Philip pointed to Christ and sought God's glory; Simon sought his own glory and wanted people's attention directed at himself.**
 - This distinction applies today: **a true spiritual leader directs glory to God; a false leader draws attention, praise, and resources to themselves.**
 - Simon's **true spiritual state is debatable** — he was baptized and outwardly followed Philip, but his internal transformation appears incomplete; the next passage (to be studied next session) will reveal his real motives.
 - After his conversion (if genuine), Simon **likely could no longer perform sorcery**, as a true believer cannot simultaneously serve God and draw power from Satan.
 - The group noted that **false signs are real but Satanic in origin** — shrines, charms, and rituals can produce tangible effects, but these come from the enemy, not God.
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Peter and John Sent to Samaria: The Holy Spirit Question

- News of Samaritans receiving the Word of God reached Jerusalem, and the apostles **sent Peter and John to Samaria** — a historically significant act of acceptance.
- This was **not a minor administrative visit**: it symbolized the unity of the church across the Jewish-Samaritan divide, affirming that Samaritans were now full members of the body of Christ.
- John's presence is especially poignant: **earlier in his ministry, John had asked Jesus to call down fire from heaven to destroy a Samaritan village** that rejected them — yet now he came to bless and pray for Samaritans.
- This transformation in John — from hatred to love — was cited as evidence of **genuine inner renewal by the Holy Spirit**, consistent with the emphasis on love in 1, 2, and 3 John.
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- The apostles **laid hands on the Samaritans and prayed**, after which the Samaritans received the Holy Spirit — even though they had already believed and been baptized.

Theological Discussion: Two Works of the Holy Spirit

This was the session's most detailed theological exchange, addressing a genuinely contested passage.

The Core Question

- The Samaritans had **believed, been baptized, and accepted the Word of God** — yet the text states the Holy Spirit "had not yet fallen on any of them."
- This raises the question: **were they truly saved before the apostles laid hands on them?**

The Distinction Explained

Three related but distinct concepts were identified:

1. **The Holy Spirit's inward work in conversion**: Without the Spirit opening a person's heart, no one can believe. This work is invisible and internal — it is what makes salvation possible. Every true believer has experienced this.
2. **Baptism of the Holy Spirit (Paul's usage)**: In Paul's letters, "baptism of the Holy Spirit" refers to conversion — being united with Christ through faith. This is the inward, regenerative work.

3. **The "pouring out" / Pentecostal empowerment of the Holy Spirit (Jesus's usage in Acts 1):** This is a distinct, outward, visible, and tangible experience — seen at Pentecost in fire, wind, and tongues, and repeated on other occasions when the ground shook.

Key Conclusions

- The **Samaritans were already saved** before the apostles arrived — their belief and acceptance of the Word required the Spirit's inward work.
- The **laying on of hands and receiving of the Spirit** was an outward, Pentecostal-type empowerment — externally noticeable (Simon could see it happening), functioning as a divine seal confirming that Samaritans were fully accepted into the people of God.
- This outward empowerment **is not a one-time event** — it repeated multiple times in Acts (e.g., when believers gathered under persecution and the place shook).
- The **Samaritan woman's conversion in John 4** was cited as a parallel: she and the Samaritans who believed through her testimony were genuinely saved without any outward Pentecostal sign.
- **Warning against extremes:** Some charismatic/Pentecostal traditions wrongly require visible outward signs as proof of salvation — this is incorrect. Scripture's standard is "confess with your mouth and believe in your heart" (Romans 10).
- Believers **can and should seek to be filled with the Spirit** (Ephesians 5:18) — this is a legitimate ongoing pursuit, distinct from the moment of salvation.

Evangelism as Every Believer's Responsibility

- Philip and Stephen were chosen as **deacons for administrative/service roles** (managing relief for widows, etc.), yet both preached the gospel powerfully.
- This demonstrates that **preaching and witnessing are not reserved for pastors or missionaries** — every Christian is called to be a witness of Jesus Christ.
- The early church operated with **ordinary believers as active evangelists**, not passive recipients of professional ministry.
- The group challenged the common church attitude of "evangelism is the pastor's job" as unbiblical.